

HOROLOGICAL MASTER COLLECTION SERIES

PART I

GRAND SEIKO

Illustrated Collector's Field Guide

MASTER COLLECTION GUIDE | 2026 EDITION | AUGUST 2026

22 collector cards | 4 owned foundation pieces | historical milestones + deliberate future hunts

Precision, design and movement technology - one coherent Grand Seiko story.

COLLECTION ARCHITECTURE

The thesis

Build a compact history of Grand Seiko through design, precision and movement technology. Owned pieces remain inside the historical sequence, and every future purchase must contribute a chapter not already represented.

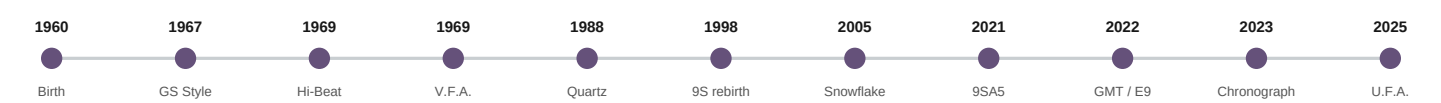
OWNED FOUNDATION

- 4520-7010 - manual Hi-Beat
- 6145-8000 - automatic Hi-Beat
- SBGE285 - Spring Drive GMT / E9
- SLGB005 - Spring Drive U.F.A.

HIGH-VALUE GAPS

- 44GS 4420-9000 - design language
- 61GS V.F.A. - precision lineage
- SBGA011 - Spring Drive icon
- 62GS - first automatic
- SLGH005 - modern mechanical architecture

COLLECTION SPINE



COLLECTION RULE

A future Grand Seiko should add a chapter, not merely another beautiful dial.

THE HUNT LIST

Where I would focus next, now that the 6145-8000 has officially joined the collection.

- | | | |
|---|-----------------------------------|--------|
| 1. | 44GS 4420-9000 | 10/10 |
| The design-language cornerstone and the highest-priority open vintage chapter. | | |
| <hr/> | | |
| 2. | 61GS V.F.A. 6185-8020 | 10/10 |
| The missing precision bridge between your vintage Hi-Beat watches and U.F.A. | | |
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| 3. | SBGA011 Original Snowflake | 10/10 |
| The Spring Drive cultural icon; choose the pre-2017 double-logo reference. | | |
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| 4. | Grand Seiko First J14070 | 9.5/10 |
| Genesis. Worth waiting for a genuinely original dial and honest case. | | |
| <hr/> | | |
| 5. | SLGH005 White Birch | 9.5/10 |
| The modern mechanical anchor: 9SA5, Hi-Beat and Evolution 9. | | |
| <hr/> | | |
| 6. | 62GS 6245-9000 | 8.5/10 |
| First automatic Grand Seiko and a distinctive bezel-free case architecture. | | |
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| 7. | SBGT241 9F Anniversary | 8/10 |
| A clever collectible way to represent Grand Seiko quartz at its most obsessive. | | |
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| 8. | SBGR001 / 9S55 | 8/10 |
| Quiet-looking but historically huge: the 1998 mechanical rebirth. | | |
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ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #01

Grand Seiko First

J14070 / Cal. 3180



Photo: Timeanagram

DATES	1960-1963
CALIBER	3180 - manual wind
DIMENSIONS	~35.0 mm diameter; ~10.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

Genesis. The first Grand Seiko and the opening statement of the brand's pursuit of precision, legibility, durability and refinement.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$4,500-\$8,000	9.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

14K gold-filled J14070 with original dial, crown and caseback medallion. Pay up for originality; avoid redials.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #02

57GS

5722-9990



Photo: Ginza Rasin

DATES	c. 1964-1967
CALIBER	5722A/B - manual wind
DIMENSIONS	~36.0 mm diameter; ~10 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The bridge from the classical First toward the sharper, more modern visual language that would culminate in the 44GS.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$1,400-\$2,300	6.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Sharp steel 5722-9990 with factory-original dial and strong medallion. Treat AD/SD dial claims cautiously unless documented.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #03

44GS

4420-9000

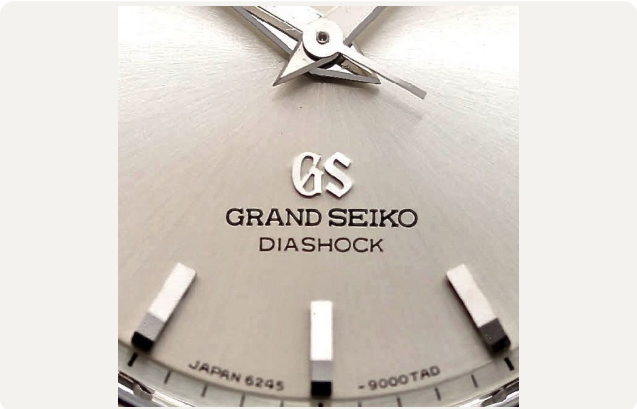


Photo: Alpha Omega

DATES 1967-1968/69
CALIBER 4420B - manual wind
DIMENSIONS ~37.8 mm diameter; ~10 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The design milestone. This reference established the Grand Seiko Style: broad planes, razor-like facets and deliberate light-shadow geometry.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$3,200-\$5,000	10 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

The sharpest honest case you can find, with intact medallion and original dial. Case geometry matters more than saving \$1,000.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #04

OWNED FOUNDATION

45GS - OWNED

4520-7010 / Cal. 4520A



Illustrated reference; specs cross-checked to Timeanagram

DATES c. 1969-1970
CALIBER 4520A - manual wind, 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS 36.8 mm diameter; ~10 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

Your vintage technical anchor. A late-1960s manual Hi-Beat Grand Seiko carrying first-generation 36,000-vph precision into a softer C-line case.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; market roughly \$1,000-\$1,600	10 / 10 - DONE

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Keep this exact 4520-7010. Preserve the clean no-date dial, original case geometry and medallion. It is the vintage starting point for your precision lineage.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #05

62GS

6245-9000



Photo: Timeline.watch

DATES	1966-1968
CALIBER	6245A - automatic
DIMENSIONS	~36.5 mm diameter; ~11.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

Grand Seiko's first automatic watch, and a historically important bezel-free case architecture still echoed in modern GS design.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$1,500-\$3,000	8.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Date-only 6245-9000, preferably with a crisp case and correct lion medallion. Cleaner and more elegant than the day-date 6246.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #06

OWNED FOUNDATION

61GS Hi-Beat - OWNED

6145-8000 / serial 800578



Photo: Marc supplied seller image

DATES	October 1968
CALIBER	6145A - automatic 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS	~36.5-37.0 mm; ~12 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

Japan's first automatic 10-beat / 36,000-vph Grand Seiko. Your early-dial example is the perfect automatic counterpart to the manual-wind 45GS.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
ACQUIRED AUG 2026 - \$1,000	9 / 10 - DONE

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Keep the early Grand Seiko dial / Grand Seiko rotor configuration, service paperwork, signed buckle and spare mainspring together as provenance.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #07

61GS V.F.A.

6185-8020



Photo: FireKids

DATES 1969-early 1970s
CALIBER 6185A - automatic 36,000 vph V.F.A.
DIMENSIONS ~37.0 mm diameter; ~11.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The vintage mechanical precision summit. V.F.A. watches were adjusted to extraordinary monthly accuracy and form the ideal bridge to modern U.F.A.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$8,000-\$14,000 typical; rare early variants higher	10 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Dream target: early 1969 short-hand, applied Suwa-logo dial without printed VFA, if originality is verified. Otherwise buy the best original printed-VFA example.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #08

95GS Quartz

SBGS001 / 9581-7000



Photo: Yahoo Japan auction archive

DATES 1988-early 1990s
CALIBER 9581 - high-accuracy quartz
DIMENSIONS ~33.5 mm diameter; ~7.7 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The 1988 return of Grand Seiko in quartz form. This is the historically exact 95GS chapter before the later 9F generation.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$500-\$900	6.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Steel SBGS001 from the first generation, ideally with original crown and bracelet/strap hardware and an unmolested slim case.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #09

9F 25th Anniversary

SBGT241



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2018 only - LE 1,500
CALIBER	9F83 - special +/-5 sec/year quartz
DIMENSIONS	39.1 x 44.6 x 10.9 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

A deliberately collectible commemoration of 25 years of 9F, revisiting the original 9F aesthetic while using a specially selected oscillator.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$2,500-\$3,200	8 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Full-set SBGT241 with sharp case and original bracelet. It tells the 9F story more vividly than a generic later 9F reference.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #10

Mechanical Rebirth

SBGR001 / 9S55



Photo: EveryWatch

DATES	1998-early 2000s
CALIBER	9S55 - automatic
DIMENSIONS	~37.0 mm diameter; ~11.3 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The 1998 rebirth of mechanical Grand Seiko and the start of the modern 9S lineage. Quiet-looking, historically enormous.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$1,800-\$3,000	8 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Early double-logo SBGR001, ideally full set. Buy on condition and completeness rather than dial drama.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #11

Automatic Spring Drive Genesis

SBGA001 / 9R65



Photo: Alpha Omega

DATES 2004-2017
CALIBER 9R65 - automatic Spring Drive
DIMENSIONS ~41.0 mm diameter; ~12.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The launch-generation automatic 9R Spring Drive Grand Seiko. It marks Spring Drive becoming a core GS technology rather than an experiment.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$2,500-\$3,500	8.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Pre-2017 double-logo SBGA001, preferably an early full-set example. The old branding makes the watch a timestamp.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #12

Original Snowflake

SBGA011



Photo: EveryWatch

DATES 2005-2017
CALIBER 9R65 - automatic Spring Drive
DIMENSIONS 41.0 x 48.6 x 12.7 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

The watch that helped make Spring Drive visually and emotionally synonymous with Grand Seiko. A modern icon with real historical weight.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$3,300-\$4,200	10 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

SBGA011 specifically, not SBGA211: the pre-2017 SEIKO / Grand Seiko double-logo dial is the more historically expressive version.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #13

Modern Hi-Beat Revival

SBGH001 / 9S85



Photo: Sanoya

DATES 2009-2017 era
CALIBER 9S85 - automatic 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS ~40.2 mm diameter; ~13.0 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

The return of automatic 36,000-vph Grand Seiko roughly four decades after the 61GS. A direct modern echo of the vintage Hi-Beat era.

TARGET / MARKET

\$2,700-\$3,500

PRIORITY

7 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Early double-logo SBGH001, ideally full set. Lower priority only because your 45GS and now 61GS already own this historical theme so well.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #14

Spring Drive 8 Days

SBGD001 / 9R01



Photo: Time+Tide

DATES 2016-2017
CALIBER 9R01 - manual Spring Drive, 8 days
DIMENSIONS 43.0 x 51.4 x ~13.2-13.5 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

First Grand Seiko made by the Micro Artist Studio. The 8-day movement and rear power-reserve display push Spring Drive into haute horlogerie.

TARGET / MARKET

\$35,000-\$55,000+

PRIORITY

7.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

SBGD001 rather than later SBGD201: the original pre-rebrand, first-series expression. Full provenance is highly desirable.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #15

First Re-Creation

SBGW253



Photo: Feldmar Watch Co.

DATES	2017 only - LE 1,960
CALIBER	9S64 - manual wind
DIMENSIONS	38.0 x 45.7 x 11.5 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

A modern steel re-creation of the 1960 First, released at the moment Grand Seiko stepped forward with a more independent global brand identity.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$5,000-\$6,500	7 if First owned; 9 if not

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Steel SBGW253 over the precious-metal sisters for wearability and value. Full set, clean case, original strap/buckle preferred.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #16

Micro Artist 9R02 Masterpiece

SBGZ001



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2019 - LE 30
CALIBER	9R02 - manual Spring Drive
DIMENSIONS	38.5 x 43.7 x 9.8 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

An artisanal Spring Drive summit: hand-finished 9R02, 84-hour reserve and hand-engraved platinum case from the Micro Artist Studio.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$55,000-\$70,000+ estimated	6.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

SBGZ001 itself, with complete provenance. At this level, condition, original accessories and service history matter enormously.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #17

First 9SA5

SLGH002



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2020 - LE 100
CALIBER	9SA5 - automatic Hi-Beat 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS	40.0 x 47.0 x 11.7 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

The first production watch with 9SA5: Dual Impulse Escapement, free-sprung balance and 80 hours of reserve at 36,000 vph.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$28,000-\$36,000 estimated	8.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Full-set SLGH002 in 18K yellow gold. This is the collector-first choice if you want the literal beginning of the 9SA5 era.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #18

White Birch

SLGH005



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2021-present
CALIBER	9SA5 - automatic Hi-Beat 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS	40.0 x 47.0 x 11.7 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

The wearable flagship expression of the new 9SA5 mechanical architecture and Evolution 9 design language. A modern mechanical cornerstone.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$6,000-\$7,500	9.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Regular-production SLGH005, bought lightly used and unpolished. Far more wearable value than SLGH002 while telling nearly the same technical story.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #19

OWNED FOUNDATION

Mist Flake GMT - OWNED

SBGE285 / 9R66



Illustrated reference; specs verified to Grand Seiko

DATES 2022-present
CALIBER 9R66 - automatic Spring Drive GMT
DIMENSIONS 41.0 x 48.3 x 13.9 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

Your modern practical anchor: Evolution 9, High-Intensity Titanium, true traveler GMT and mature Spring Drive in one highly wearable package.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; Aug 2026 market about \$6,200-\$6,300	9 / 10 - DONE

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Keep your SBGE285. It already fills the modern Spring Drive GMT / Evolution 9 sport chapter extremely well, so no duplicate GMT is needed.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #20

Kodo Constant-Force Tourbillon

SLGT003 / 9ST1



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES 2022 - LE 20
CALIBER 9ST1 - manual complication
DIMENSIONS 43.8 mm diameter; 12.9 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS

Grand Seiko's first mechanical complication, combining a tourbillon and constant-force mechanism coaxially on one axis. A true technical landmark.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$250,000-\$325,000 estimated	4 / 10 (financial gravity)

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Original SLGT003, full provenance, if the laws of household finance temporarily cease to apply. Historically essential; practically optional.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #21

Tentagraph

SLGC001 / 9SC5



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2023-present
CALIBER	9SC5 - automatic Hi-Beat chronograph
DIMENSIONS	43.2 x 51.5 x 15.3 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

Grand Seiko's first mechanical chronograph, built around a 36,000-vph movement with a three-day reserve. A major complication milestone.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$9,000-\$11,500	7.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Original blue-dial SLGC001 launch reference. Mandatory wrist test before buying: the historical importance is easier than the dimensions.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #22

OWNED FOUNDATION

Violet Dawn - OWNED

SLGB005 / 9RB2



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2025 - LE 1,300
CALIBER	9RB2 Spring Drive U.F.A. - +/-20 sec/year
DIMENSIONS	37.0 x 44.3 x 11.4 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

The U.F.A. precision milestone and the modern endpoint of Grand Seiko's long accuracy obsession. A cornerstone of your collection already.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; retail launched at \$11,100	10 / 10 - DONE

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Keep the full set and enjoy it. In the collection thesis, this is the modern anchor for a 4520 -> V.F.A. -> U.F.A. precision sequence.

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

HISTORICAL BASIS

Milestones and modern specifications are grounded primarily in Grand Seiko / Seiko historical material, official collection pages and press information. Vintage dimensions, dial variants and production details are cross-checked against specialist archives, auction records and reputable dealer examples.

MARKET METHODOLOGY

Target ranges are working acquisition bands rather than appraisals. They are intended to identify sensible buying territory, not guarantee resale value. Vintage condition, originality, service history and completeness can move a watch materially above or below the stated range.

VINTAGE BUYING PRINCIPLE

For 44GS, 45GS, 62GS, 61GS and V.F.A., case geometry and dial originality are part of the historical content of the watch. A cheaper polished or redialed example can be the more expensive mistake.

OWNED-WATCH STATUS

This edition updates the collection to four owned foundations: 4520-7010, 6145-8000, SBGE285 and SLGB005. The recently acquired October 1968 6145-8000 is recorded at the \$1,000 acquisition price and retains its early Grand Seiko dial / rotor story.

PHOTOGRAPHY POLICY

Reference photography is used to make the guide practical at a glance. Images are credited on-card and again in the photography index. Two owned references retain clearly labeled illustrations where a local photograph of the exact watch was not available in the source bundle.

COLLECTION RULE

Owned watches remain in their historical place rather than being separated from targets. Every proposed purchase must answer one question: what does this add that the collection does not already say?

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Image credits used in this edition. Owned-watch photographs are identified where supplied by Marc.

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Timeanagram

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Ginza Rasin

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04. 45GS 4520-7010

Illustrated reference / Timeanagram specs

05. 62GS

Timeline.watch

06. 61GS Hi-Beat 6145-8000

Marc supplied seller image

07. 61GS V.F.A.

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08. 95GS Quartz

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20. Kodo Constant-Force Tourbillon

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Grand Seiko